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POPE FRANCIS 1936-2025

To those on life's margins, a champion

Outpouring of sorrow, from the pews to positions of power

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

The death of Pope Francis, 88, after a long illness Monday prompted an outpouring of condolences from church and civic leaders across the region, as well as admiration among the Catholic laity for the Argentinian pontiff's humility, simplicity, and advocacy for the most vulnerable.

From a Natick church service, where Boston Archbishop Richard Henning mourned the pope's passing, to Boston City Hall and the state's congressional delegation, Francis was recalled as a cleric who had championed the causes of the impoverished and persecuted, while prodding the

secretive bureaucracy of the Roman Catholic Church to discuss reforms more openly.

At the foot of the altar in St. Patrick's in Natick stood a gold-framed photo of the pontiff, surrounded by arrangements of lilies, hydrangeas, and daffodils laid out for the Easter season. The pope, a Jesuit who was elected to the papacy in 2013, died a day after appearing in a wheelchair on Easter Sunday to bless a large crowd assembled in St. Peter's Square at the Vatican.

Among those in the pews Monday at St. Patrick's was Donna McKenzie, a Natick native and theologian who rushed to

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AFF/GETTY IMAGES/FILE 2015

Pope Francis urged the Catholic clergy and political leaders to reach out to migrants, the poor, and the destitute.

In US, a mixed history

Pope Francis sought change but faced resistance from the conservative wing. **A6.**

The next pope

Cardinals will decide whether to keep Francis' approach or restore doctrinaire leadership. **A6.**

Ignoring pomp and pageantry, he wove a legacy built on opening church to those most in need

By Jason Horowitz
and Jim Yardley
NEW YORK TIMES

VATICAN CITY — Pope Francis, who rose from modest means in Argentina to become the first Jesuit and Latin American pontiff, who clashed bitterly with traditionalists in his push for a more inclusive Roman Catholic Church, and who spoke out tirelessly for migrants, the marginalized, and the health of the planet, died on Monday at the Vatican's Casa Santa Marta. He was 88.

The pope's death was announced by the Vatican in a statement on X, a day after Pope Francis appeared in his wheelchair to bless the faithful in St. Peter's Square on Easter Sunday. The Vatican said later that he died of a cerebral stroke that led to irreversible heart failure.

Throughout his 12-year papacy, Pope Francis was a change agent, having inherited a Vatican in disarray in 2013 after the stunning resignation of his predecessor, Benedict XVI, a standard-bearer of Roman Catholic conservatism.

Pope Francis steadily steered the church in another direction, restocking its leadership with a diverse array of bishops who shared his pastoral, welcoming approach as he sought to open up the church. Many rank-and-file Catholics approved, believing that the church had become inward-looking and distant from ordinary people.

He reached out to migrants, the poor, and the destitute, to victims of sexual abuse by Catholic clergy members, and to alienated gay Catholics. He traveled to often-forgotten and far-flung

POPE FRANCIS, Page A8

Harvard sues over funding freeze

Argues Trump's bid for control is abuse of power

By Mike Damiano
and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University sued the Trump administration on Monday, arguing the government's use of research funding cuts as leverage to exert control over Harvard's academic affairs, as well as its admissions, hiring, and diversity practices, represents an unconstitutional abuse of federal power.

In a lawsuit filed in federal court in Boston, the university's lawyers contended the government's "attempt to coerce and control Harvard" tramples First Amendment protections of academic freedom. They also ar-

'We applaud Harvard for taking this step . . . '

TED MITCHELL, *president, American Council on Education*

gue the Trump administration's actions violate federal laws and regulations dictating how federal agencies investigate and punish institutions accused of civil rights violations.

In an open letter Monday, Harvard president Alan Garber said the demands were an attempt to "impose unprecedented and improper control over the university." Harvard is suing "to halt the funding freeze because it is unlawful and beyond the government's authority," he wrote.

The Trump administration has accused Harvard of violating civil rights law by allegedly failing to protect Jewish students from discrimination and harassment. Its pressure campaign against Harvard is part of the administration's wider crackdown on elite universities, which it accuses of indoctrinat-

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Marc Tortell from Germany started the 129th Boston Marathon in high spirits in Hopkinton.

129TH BOSTON MARATHON

ONE GLORIOUS DAY OF SHARED GRIT AND JOY

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

Clear skies, a cool breeze. History celebrated, history made. The clanging cowbells, the hollering college kids, and the boisterous crowds at their loudest and proudest.

There is no such thing as a perfect Boston Marathon.

This was close.

It was a day to make the most of the meteorological good luck (temperatures hit the low 60s) for the estimated more than half million who cheered the 30,000 runners on at the 129th Boston Marathon.

It was a day of firsts. Kenya's Sharon Lokedi obliterated the record for fastest time among the women's elite runners by nearly three minutes, an astounding feat even to her: "I didn't even believe it," she said. The new time to beat is 2:17:22.

Also lasts. Des Linden, who in 2018 became



Women's Elite
SHARON LOKEDI
2:17:22



Men's Elite
JOHN KORIR
2:04:45



Men's Elite Wheelchair
MARCEL HUG
1:21:34



Women's Elite Wheelchair
SUSANNAH SCARONI
1:35:20

the first American to win the marathon in more than 30 years, and in the process to many running fans an honorary Bostonian, announced just before the race that this would be her last one as a competitor.

Elite men's winner John Korir finished first despite taking a tumble to the ground in the very first steps of the race, and did so with a nearly record-setting time of 2:04:45 — the second-fastest winning time in course history. Marathons are a family affair for Korir. His victory followed a victory from his brother, Wesley, in 2012.

"For us, two brothers winning Boston, I think we're happy now," the younger Korir said Monday.

For Marcel Hug, the champion wheelchair racer for the third year in a row, it came on the 50th anniversary of wheelchair racing in Boston. "It's a special day," said the Swiss paralymp-

MARATHON, Page C8

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Education advocates are again pushing the State House to overhaul how reading is taught. B1.

The National Labor Relations Board rejected Mass General Brigham's attempt to reduce the size of the bargaining unit

of physicians seeking to unionize. **D1.**

President Trump offered strong support for Pete Hegseth after concerns were raised over a report that the defense secretary shared military attack plans in a group chat. **A2.**

The National Park Service has been quietly removing from its website pages highlighting Black and LGBTQ+ history in the Boston area. **B1.**

Pitcher Walker Buehler led the Red Sox to an early victory over the White Sox. **C1.**



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Getting the gray out

Tuesday: Clouds yield to sun. High 72-77, low 47-52.

Wednesday: Clear. High 64-69, low 46-51.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C12.**